



KINGDOM HALL MAINTENANCE GUIDELINES

MAINTENANCE PROGRAM

Overview

These guidelines have been designed to outline how the *Maintenance Program* should operate and the correlation between the *Job Cards*, *Maintenance Manual*, *Maintenance Calendar*, *History Cards*, *Workgroups*, the *Safety Coordinator* and the use of *Project Tasks* via JW Hub. These guidelines should be used in conjunction with *Kingdom Hall Maintenance Program Workflow* (K-202) and “*Shepherd the Flock of God*”. —1 Peter 5:2 (sfl).

The Kingdom Hall *Maintenance Program* has been designed to assist congregation maintenance coordinators or operating committees to keep our places of worship clean, tidy and in good working order, so as to bring honour to Jehovah. Any brother or sister approved by the body of elders and willing to assist should be trained to take part in the program. If effectively implemented, the program will result in fewer breakdowns and repairs, and reduced operating costs.

Job Cards

Job Cards are the pillar of the *Maintenance Program*. They ensure each building element or piece of equipment receives systematic inspection and service/repair. *Job Cards* outline what work and tasks need to be done, and are used to schedule maintenance work. A review of upcoming *Job Cards* will allow time to ensure materials and supplies are on hand to complete the tasks and ensure all can have a full share.

Maintenance Manual

Each Kingdom Hall has a *Maintenance Manual*. It outlines how repairs and maintenance should be performed and contains a written description of the equipment and systems specific to the facility. The manual also explains maintenance requirements that are not addressed in the manufacturers’ manuals.

Maintenance Calendar

The *Maintenance Calendar* shows the *Job Cards* that must be completed each month, or as required. It can also reveal if any work is being neglected. The operating committee or maintenance coordinator is responsible to make sure that the *Maintenance Calendar* and program is followed.

Although the frequency of each *Job Card* is set by the Local Design/Construction Department (LDC), the best time of year to perform the work is left with the local body of elders to determine. The month assigned to complete each *Job Card* can be adjusted as required.

History Cards

If any repairs are carried out on a major piece of equipment or building element this should be noted on the *History Card*. *History Cards* provide an overview of work already performed. The summary created is valuable for resolving repeated maintenance problems. *History Cards* are designed to note observations that will affect future maintenance and additional work carried out that is not outlined during regular service. In most cases the *History Cards* will not need to be updated after routine maintenance. *History Cards* are assigned to a key building system or serviceable equipment of high value, such as air-conditioning units.

Workgroups

Each building element at the Kingdom Hall has been added to one of six *Workgroups*: Building, Civil, Electrical, Mechanical, Equipment and Technical. Each approved volunteer is assigned to one or more *Workgroups*. Each *Workgroup* should be assigned a brother who will act as a coordinator. He has the responsibility to make sure that all the assigned *Job Cards* and repairs associated with that *Workgroup* are carried out in line with the *Maintenance Calendar*. Typically, each member of the operating committee would serve as a *Workgroup* coordinator. Multiple *Workgroups* could be combined under the same coordinator depending on the size of the facility and the availability of volunteers. A *Workgroup* coordinator does not necessarily need to be skilled in that trade or field, however, he must be a spiritual man who is organised and able to communicate well. —sfl 21:14.

Process

The *Job Cards* and *Maintenance Calendar* have been designed so that preventative maintenance and repairs can be carried out by skilled volunteers at regular intervals. A *Workgroup* coordinator may assign one or more volunteers to complete one or more *Job Cards* at a time. Primarily, the *Workgroup* coordinator and assigned volunteer should work together to schedule a suitable time for the work to be completed that will not interfere with other theocratic events. However, some *Job Cards* and repairs could be grouped together and scheduled to be completed at the same time as one of the scheduled major cleans. —sfl 21:5.

Record Keeping

The maintenance coordinator, a member of the Kingdom Hall Operating Committee, or a brother who is assisting the maintenance coordinator or the operating committee will be responsible for keeping a record of the status of the local maintenance program on behalf of the congregation(s) using the Kingdom Hall. To do so, the *Project Tasks* feature on JW Hub should be used. He will need to have a current *Application to Become a Local Design/Construction Volunteer* (DC-50) to access the *Project Tasks* feature. This brother will be known as the Kingdom Hall Contact (KHC). He should be a responsible brother with good technical ability and known for being an effective communicator to care for the administrative functions of the program.

Safety Coordinator

If a Kingdom Hall has an operating committee this assignment should be given to one of its members. (*sfl* 21:17) The primary purpose of this role is to provide reminders and promote safety at the facility. He should be kind and considerate when providing suggestions and direction regarding safety. He should also be very familiar with *Working Together Safely—Standards for Theocratic Construction and Maintenance* (DC-82).

Achieving an Accident-Free Environment

Our view of safety reflects our spirituality. All of us have the responsibility to stop any activity that poses an immediate threat to someone's safety. The Bible highlights the importance of safety measures, as well as the consequences of ignoring them. —2 Kings 1:2.

Applying scriptural principles to establish and maintain a safe working environment, even in small maintenance matters, demonstrates our desire to imitate Jehovah's view of the sacredness of life. —Deut. 22:8.

One way to improve safety is by using the Hierarchy of Controls. This means using different methods that can eliminate or control risks. Often a combination is best. When analysing which to use, the order of preference that should be followed is:

1. Eliminate the hazard
2. Control the risk (replace the hazard)
3. Prevent access to hazard (isolate)
4. Reduce the risk (change the process)
5. Use personal protective equipment

All work is to be performed in harmony with the organization's safety standards. All who assist with the *Maintenance Program* should be thoroughly familiar with *Working Together Safely—Standards for Theocratic Construction and Maintenance* (DC-82).